

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 21, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 12:23-40

23 Now these were the numbers of the divisions that were equipped for war, and came to David at Hebron to turn over the kingdom of Saul to him, according to the word of the Lord:

24 of the sons of Judah bearing shield and spear, six thousand eight hundred armed for war;

25 of the sons of Simeon, mighty men of valor fit for war, seven thousand one hundred;

26 of the sons of Levi four thousand six hundred;

27 Jehoiada, the leader of the Aaronites, and with him three thousand seven hundred;

28 Zadok, a young man, a valiant warrior, and from his father's house twenty-two captains;

29 of the sons of Benjamin, relatives of Saul, three thousand (until then the greatest part of them had remained loyal to the house of Saul);

30 of the sons of Ephraim twenty thousand eight hundred, mighty men of valor, famous men throughout their father's house;

31 of the half-tribe of Manasseh eighteen thousand, who were designated by name to come and make David king;

32 of the sons of Issachar who had understanding of the times, to know what Israel ought to do, their chiefs were two hundred; and all their brethren were at their command;

33 of Zebulun there were fifty thousand who went out to battle, expert in war with all weapons of war, stouthearted men who could keep ranks;

34 of Naphtali one thousand captains, and with them thirty-seven thousand with shield and spear;

35 of the Danites who could keep battle formation, twenty-eight thousand six hundred;

36 of Asher, those who could go out to war, able to keep battle formation, forty thousand;
37 of the Reubenites and the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh, from the other side
of the Jordan, one hundred and twenty thousand armed for battle with every kind of
weapon of war.

38 All these men of war, who could keep ranks, came to Hebron with a loyal heart, to
make David king over all Israel; and all the rest of Israel were of one mind to make David
king.

39 And they were there with David three days, eating and drinking, for their brethren had
prepared for them.

40 Moreover those who were near to them, from as far away as Issachar and Zebulun and
Naphtali, were bringing food on donkeys and camels, on mules and oxen—provisions of
flour and cakes of figs and cakes of raisins, wine and oil and oxen and sheep abundantly,
for there was joy in Israel.

II. Key Summary

- Armed men from every tribe came to David at Hebron to turn Saul's kingdom over to him according to the word of the Lord; the list even includes Benjamin, Saul's own tribe, and the Levites, who were not required to fight.
 - The text singles out two tribes for a specific trait: the chiefs of Issachar "had understanding of the times, to know what Israel ought to do," and the men of Zebulun were "stouthearted" (not of a double heart) and "could keep ranks."
 - All these men came to Hebron with a loyal heart to make David king, and the rest of Israel was of one mind about it; they ate and drank with David for three days while people brought loads of food on donkeys, camels, mules, and oxen, for there was joy in Israel.
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III. Passage Analysis

A whole heart is what keeps the ranks together

"Too many like to break the ranks, and do God's work independently. Fifty men who act together will do greater execution than five hundred acting apart... Unity is strength; and in their efforts to overthrow the kingdom of Satan it is most essential that

the soldiers of Christ move in rank and keep step." [1]

The men of Zebulun could keep ranks precisely because they were not of a double heart — their hearts were not split in two, so they could hold their place in the line. When someone carries two plans at once, it is not only that person who wavers; the whole row falls apart with them.

Where the king is enthroned, joy follows

"A noble feast was made upon this occasion, for there was joy in Israel... when the throne of Christ is set up in a soul, there is, or ought to be, great joy in that soul." [2]

Israel's joy did not come from winning a battle. It came from finally putting the right king in place together, and then sitting down to eat and drink for three days. Put God back where He belongs, and joy follows — and it is joy a whole group gets to share.

IV. Reflection Question

Think back to the last time you finished something together with a group — a group project, a club rehearsal, a team practice: which parts did you actually do the way everyone agreed on, and which one part did you quietly do your own way instead?

In today's passage those soldiers came to Hebron able to keep ranks and not of a double heart, and that is how all Israel became of one mind to make David king — and ended up eating and drinking together for three days, with joy in Israel.

References

[1] Enduring Word (David Guzik), David Guzik's commentary quoting F. B. Meyer, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-12/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary, https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_012.cfm